

Title PL The Masquerade Continues: Doppelgänger Interferes with Polish Elections 31/05/2025

Summary

- Between April 11 and May 21, the Russian-sanctioned influence operation Doppelgänger published 321 Polish-language tweets, continuing the same pattern of behaviour we flagged in a previous report. Considering we are using X's API to track the operation, X should be able to stop Doppelgänger altogether. X not doing so could be a violation of the DSA.
- The operation promoted anti-EU, anti-Ukrainian, and anti-Polish government narratives.
- Doppelgänger tweets received 1,229,000 authentic views and 3879 likes.
- The operation is posing as Polish citizens, amplifying articles from Polish media, and has their content commented on other users' content hundreds of times per post.
- Reported tweets to X, X took them all down. X should apply a more proactive and mitigate the operation.

Incident

Between April 11 and May 21, the Russian-sanctioned influence operation Doppelgänger published 321 Polish-language tweets, discrediting and promoting different candidates, spreading anti-EU narratives, discrediting the current government, and discrediting continued support to Ukraine. On the 17th of May, during the Polish electoral silence period, the influence operation published at least 4 tweets promoting candidates, violating the silence period. The operation continues its activity despite X being made aware in April about the operation's activities, in a [report](#) by Alliance4Europe and Debunk.org. The operation continues to operate, which we find concerning as we have provided X with the technical indicators we are using to track the influence operation automatically, using their own API via Meltwater. X's inability to respond to these threats could be a violation of the Digital Services Act Articles 34 and 35.

Narrative

Meta narrative: The EU oppresses Poland; Poland Should not support Ukraine; The Polish government is failing.
Sub-narratives: The EU are coloniser that de facto rules over Poland; The EU is responsible for economic crises; The EU is responsible for worsening of the citizens' welfare; Politicians are subservient to foreign forces. Government prioritisation of military spending over social services; Polish Government is escalating the war; peace should be the main goal to safeguard citizens; The Polish government is mishandling migration; The Polish government is mishandling healthcare; The Polish government is mishandling the national debt

Impact

Reach: The tweets received over 271,000 inauthentic quote tweets, likely over 1,229,000 authentic views and 3879 likes.

Outcome: N/A.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [T0136.005: Cultivate Support for Initiative](#) – Promotes Nawrocki.

Objective: [T0066: Degrade Adversary](#) – Propagating negative portrayals of Trzaskowski, the EU and members of the Polish government aiming to delegitimise their authority and reduce public trust in their leadership.

[T0084.004: Appropriate Content](#) – The operation legitimises their narratives by linking to Polish media.

[T0116.001: Post Inauthentic Social Media Comment](#) – The content of the operation is amplified by commenting it onto authentic users posts.

[T0128.002: Conceal Network Identity](#) – The accounts hide their affiliations.

[T0143.002: Fabricated Persona](#) + [T0097.101: Local Persona](#) - The accounts portray themselves as Polish citizens.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Action Taken: Reported tweets to X via email. Resulted in accounts being taken down; Shared report to European government entities and media.

Recommendations: X should take a more proactive approach and take down Doppelgänger content as they appear. If we can automatically track the activities of the operation using X's API, so can they.

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
Link	Russia	Link	Saman Nazari, Alliance4Europe. Jakub Kubs, GLOBSEC. Wojciech Solak, Independent Researcher Aleksandra Wojtowicz, Independent Researcher	X	